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Seventh-day Adventist Master Guide Portfolio Guide

Executive Summary: This report provides a comprehensive guide for Master Guide candidates to assemble a complete portfolio under the SDA Master Guide program. It identifies key official sources (General Conference and Division/Union youth ministries, Master Guide manuals, and conference guidelines) [1] [2]. We summarize the Master Guide curriculum (sections on Leadership/Wisdom, Lifestyle/Stature, Spiritual Growth/Favor with God, and Community Development/Favor with Man) [1] [3]. For each competency area (skills, leadership, teaching, camping, first aid, spiritual development, service projects, mentoring, recordkeeping), we list explicit portfolio sections with required evidence (e.g. workshop certificates, honors workbooks, journals, reports) and give assessment notes. Sample templates (cover page, table of contents, logs, lesson plans, rubrics, reference letters, certificates, photo consent forms) are described. We outline common evaluation criteria and rubrics used by SDA leaders, and propose an organization/layout and printable checklist for the portfolio. We provide three illustrative example portfolio entries and a suggested timeline for assembling all materials. Finally, we discuss ethical and legal considerations (child protection training, background checks, photo releases) [4] [5], and link to primary manuals and further reading. All information is drawn from official SDA sources, especially the Master Guide Curriculum Manual and the NAD/GC Master Guide guidelines [1] [6].

Key Official Sources

- **General Conference Master Guide Curriculum:** The 2022 *Master Guide Curriculum Manual* (Adventist Youth Ministries) outlines all requirements [1] [3]. It details prerequisites, workshops, and competencies for the Master Guide program. (Available online at GC Youth Ministries or Adventist.org.)
- **Master Guide Record Card & Requirements:** The official *Master Guide Record Card* summarizes all investiture requirements (e.g. local church board recommendation, years, portfolio review) [6].
- **Division/Union Youth Ministries:** Many divisions/unions (e.g. NAD, EUD, etc.) publish Master Guide guides. The North American Division (NAD) “Master Guide Portfolio” workbook provides forms and checklists [2], and Union websites often host PDFs.
- **Local Conference Guidelines:** Each conference/mission may have specific portfolio review forms or rubrics (often provided by the conference youth director). These should be obtained locally.
- **Club Ministries (NAD) and Pathfinder Ministries:** Official sites like Club Ministries/NAD Pathfinder Ministries (clubministries.org) provide additional resources (e.g. record cards, leader training materials) to be used in documentation [1] [2].
- **Master Guide Workshop Materials:** The curriculum manual (p. 40–66) includes workshop topics (Leadership training, Education, Storytelling, etc.) which are needed as portfolio evidence.

Master Guide Curriculum Overview

The Master Guide curriculum is divided into four sections (modeled on Luke 2:52, the *holistic growth model* [7]):

- **I. Leadership Identity & Growth (Wisdom):** Candidates must complete approved leadership workshops (e.g. Teen Leadership, MG Training, possibly Certified Master Guide training) and study *Education* by Ellen G. White [8]. They read a book on Adventist leadership, complete surveys (Spiritual Gifts and Personality) with written reflections, and serve at least one year on Adventurer/Pathfinder staff or teaching Sabbath School (attending 75% of meetings, teaching awards/honors, and earning the "Christian Storytelling" honor) [8] [9]. This section emphasizes personal leadership development and mentorship.
- **II. Lifestyle Development (Stature):** Focuses on physical and practical skills. Tasks include completing a significant **fitness program or honor** (options range from the Physical Fitness honor, Sportsman Master Award, AY Silver/Gold fitness sections, to a doctor-approved fitness routine) [10]. Candidates must earn specific honors related to camping and safety: Basic Water Safety, Camp Safety, Camping Skills I & II, and Temperance [11]. Additionally, they earn any three of Camping Skills III/IV, Backpacking, Basic Rescue, Knot Tying, Orienteering, Fire Building & Camp Cookery, Ecology, Nutrition, Drilling & Marching, or Stewardship [12]. A current **First Aid & CPR certificate** (Red Cross or equivalent) must be held [13]. This section builds camping, survival, and health competencies.
- **III. Spiritual Growth (Favor with God):** Emphasizes Bible and Spirit of Prophecy study and personal devotion. Requirements include *Bible reading*: either read/listen to all four Gospels and *The Desire of Ages*, or use the "Christ the Way" Encounter Plan devotional (covering the Gospels) [14], with two "Share Section" reflection activities. Maintain a one-month devotional journal [15]. Read/listen to *Steps to Christ* with two share activities [16]. Write a one-paragraph personal reflection on each of the 28 Fundamental Beliefs [17]. Then **teaching ministry**: either teach a 3-month Bible/baptismal class, or teach five selected Fundamental Belief topics (e.g. Creation, Salvation, Sabbath, Sanctuary, Second Coming, etc.) at a church-approved program [18]. Finally, delve into Adventist heritage: earn the Sanctuary honor or attend a workshop (with two shares) [19], and study Adventist history (Pioneer Heritage honor, *Tell the World* or *Keepers of the Flame* video series, or a church history book) with two share activities [20].
- **IV. Community Development (Favor with Man):** Focuses on outreach and service. Candidates must earn the **Personal Evangelism honor** [21] and participate in actual evangelistic outreach (as verified by the Pastor/Youth director). They must earn any three honors from Cultural Diversity Appreciation, Peacemaker, Social Media, one ADRA-focused honor, or one Household Arts honor [22]. They help organize **three local church social/fellowship events** (e.g. potlucks, picnics, visits) [23]. Finally, they must do one major service involvement: meet with a government agency or NGO for a community project, or volunteer 3+ months with ADRA/ACS [24]. This section builds evangelism, social-service, and stewardship skills.

The **Share Section** (interwoven through the curriculum) requires ongoing creative sharing of learning (e.g. giving out inspirational cards, posting quotes with reflections, making a video/podcast, group discussion on evangelism, or leading a devotional) [25].

All requirements (sections I–IV and Share) must be documented in the candidate's portfolio and approved by the conference youth committee [6] [26]. The Master Guide program spans *at least one year and at most three years* [6] [26].

Portfolio Structure and Required Evidence

A Master Guide portfolio typically has separate sections corresponding to the curriculum areas. For each competency area, the portfolio should include specific evidence. The table below compares each section of the curriculum with the **required evidence** and some **assessment considerations**. (See also the NA Division *Master Guide Portfolio* workbook for suggested portfolio pages and documentation forms [2] [27].)

Section / Competency	Evidence / Portfolio Examples	Evaluation Criteria / Notes
Leadership Identity & Growth (Wisdom)	- Certificates or verification of approved leadership workshops (Youth/Teen Leadership, Master Guide Training, etc.) - Reflection papers (e.g. one-page on *Education*) with mentor signature - Book reports on selected leadership book (with proofs of sharing activities) - Spiritual Gifts and Personality survey results and two-page reflections (typed or handwritten) [28] - Records of one-year club service: attendance log for staff meetings, summary of awards taught (3 Adventurer or 2 Pathfinder honors), and evidence of the Christian Storytelling honor (workbook pages, honor card) [9].	- Completeness: All listed workshops attended and reflections written. - Quality of reflections: Shows insight and application of learnings. - Leadership practice: Confirm 75% meeting attendance and documented teaching of awards. - Mentor verification of all items.
Lifestyle Development (Stature)	- Documentation of chosen fitness program: e.g. honor workbook, app printout, gym log, or doctor's note (as applicable) [29] [30]. - Completed honors workbooks for Basic Water Safety, Camp Safety, Camping Skills I & II, Temperance (each with answers, diagrams or photos of activities) [30] [31]. - Completed honors for any three additional chosen skills (Camping Skills III/IV, Backpacking, Basic Rescue, etc.), with instructor signoff or project evidence [32] [33]. - Current First Aid & CPR certificate or honor pages (valid within 2 years) [34] [35].	- Completion: All required honors and programs done and documented. - Accuracy: Answers and project records match honor requirements. - Initiative: Honors chosen show well-rounded skills. - Certification validity: First Aid/CPR up-to-date.

Section / Competency	Evidence / Portfolio Examples	Evaluation Criteria / Notes
Spiritual Growth (Favor with God)	- Reading logs or calendars showing dates/ read chapters for Gospels, *Desire of Ages*, *Steps to Christ* [36] . - Devotional journal (at least 1 month) with entries summarizing insights and personal growth, signed by mentor if possible [37] . - Two “Share Section” artifacts for each reading requirement (e.g. copy of an inspirational card, printed blog post, link to a recorded video/podcast, notes from group discussion, devotional outline) [38] [25] . - Twenty-eight short belief summaries (one per fundamental belief) with key scripture references [39] [40] . - Lesson plans/materials from five fundamental-belief lessons OR baptismal class taught (outline, handouts, attendance register) [41] [42] . - Sanctuary or Pioneer honor workbook pages and proof of attending the required workshop or completing the video series (e.g. worksheets, notes) [42] [43] .	- Depth of study: Summaries and journals demonstrate thoughtful understanding of beliefs and Scripture. - Teaching effectiveness: Lesson plans are Bible-based and well-structured; evidence of actual teaching given (sign-in sheets, letters of recognition). - Creativity in Share activities.
Community Development (Favor with Man)	- Personal Evangelism honor workbook, and documentation of a real evangelistic project (e.g. project report, photos, program flyers, testimonies). Letter from pastor/Pmin coordinator confirming participation [44] . - Completed honors for any three chosen (Cultural Diversity, Peacemaker, Social Media, ADRA, Household Arts) with honor cards or workbook answers [45] . - Records of three church/social events organized (e.g. event descriptions, dates, photos, participants list, program; could be committee minutes) [46] . - Report of community service project: photos of you volunteering, news article excerpt, event summary (date, place, mission, your role) [47] . - For ADRA outreach: letter/certificate from ADRA/ACS supervisor confirming service.	- Outreach impact: Events and service should demonstrate community benefit and candidate’s active role. - Communication: Reports are clear and factual (dates, numbers, activities). - Initiative: Evidence of collaboration with church or community agencies. - Must have at least three distinct service events.

Section / Competency	Evidence / Portfolio Examples	Evaluation Criteria / Notes
General Portfolio Documentation	- **Cover Page** and **Table of Contents** (with dates, candidate info) - **Master Guide Candidate Info sheet** (name, contact, church, mentor, etc.) - **Activity Logs** (attendance, meetings, training sessions; e.g. pages for workshops, hikes, meetings). - **Mentor Evaluations or Rubrics:** Signed checklists verifying each requirement (often provided by Conference). - **Reference Letters:** Pastor or Adventurer/Pathfinder director recommendation for character and service. (Some conferences require church board endorsement [6].) - **Certifications:** Copies of Certificates (Baptism, staff training, first aid, awards) and a photo checklist (identification, group photos of events) [6]. - **Appendices:** Blank forms (shooting incident report, risk assessment) if any; Code of Conduct or background check confirmation.	- Completeness: All forms and templates filled; nothing missing. - Organization: Clearly labeled sections, indexed with TOC. - Professionalism: Neat presentation, photos captioned, no confidential data improperly displayed. - Verification: Mentor/committee signatures on key pages (as required by NAD guidelines). - Compliance: Include evidence of required child safety training and clearances [4].

Each competency's evidence must be organized and annotated. For example, a **skills** section might contain honor workbooks and related photos; a **teaching** section might include lesson plans with learning objectives and feedback. The NAD Portfolio workbook suggests including **Appendix** documents such as consent forms and code of conduct [48]. Where possible, evidence should be dated and initialed by an instructor or mentor.

Sample Portfolio Templates: The portfolio often begins with a cover page (candidate name, club, church, period) and a table of contents. Following sections include "Master Guide Candidate Information," "Requirement Worksheets" (one page per requirement), and "Documentation." Templates typically provided include: blank activity logs (for events and meetings), lesson plan forms (title, objectives, materials, steps, evaluation), evaluation rubrics or checklists (for reviewers), and photo release forms. For example, a **Cover Page** may be designed simply with the MG emblem and candidate's info, and a **TOC** lists each section with page numbers. References and certificates (e.g. the Baptism certificate or first aid certification) should be secured in clear sleeves. A **photo consent checklist** should ensure no minors' images are included without signed release [5]. (See Appendix in NAD guide for sample consent and code-of-conduct forms [48].)

Assessment Criteria and Evaluation Rubrics

The Master Guide portfolio is typically reviewed by the local Conference/Mission Master Guide committee. Common evaluation criteria include: **Completion and accuracy** (all required items present, exercises fully done), **quality of work** (depth of reflection, correctness of answers), **development of leadership and character** (evidence of initiative, Christian attitude, teamwork), and **professional presentation**. SDA reviewers often use checklists aligned with the curriculum manual. For example, a rubric might score each

task as *"Not Met/Partially Met/Fully Met"* based on whether the candidate provided evidence and demonstrated understanding. Leadership and communication skills might be assessed during an interview or observing group projects.

Below is an illustrative rubric excerpt for the **Spiritual Growth** section (actual rubrics may vary by conference):

Criteria	Excellent (3)	Satisfactory (2)	Needs Improvement (1)
Devotional Journal	Detailed entries, scriptural insights, clear growth over time [37].	Basic entries with some reflection.	Irregular entries or superficial reflection.
Beliefs Summaries	Each belief has clear key verses and personal insight [49].	Summaries present, but only partial understanding.	Incomplete coverage; key verses missing.
Teaching Lessons	Lesson plans well-structured, taught to group, positive feedback.	Plans covered topics, taught with moderate engagement.	Little evidence of teaching; no audience engagement.
Share Section Activities	Two creative shares with evidence (cards, media, discussion notes) [25].	Two shares done but minimal documentation.	Fewer than two shares or no documentation.

Other sections (e.g. Lifestyle Development) might be scored on whether the candidate *"showed marked improvement in fitness"* or *"demonstrated safe camping skills"*, etc. The final portfolio is often the basis for recommending investiture. In addition to documentation, candidates are expected to be Christian role models; mentors or pastors usually provide reference letters attesting to the candidate's character and readiness [6].

Organization, Layout, and Checklist

A well-organized portfolio is crucial. Typically, portfolios are three-ring binders or portfolios organized by section tabs (e.g. **I. Leadership**, **II. Lifestyle**, **III. Spiritual**, **IV. Community**, **V. Documentation**). Each section should start with an introduction page stating the section goals, followed by individual requirement pages. Numbering or a table (like the record card checklist) can be used.

A **checklist** (often called a "Master Guide Requirement Checklist" or "Portfolio Completion Sheet") should be maintained. This lists all curriculum items and confirms whether each is *"done"*, the date, and evidence location (e.g. "Personal Evangelism Honor – Workbook pp. 5–8, Aug 2025"). The NAD portfolio form (see Appendix) includes such a checklist in *Section V* [2] [4]. Candidates should periodically review it with their mentor to ensure nothing is missed. At portfolio submission, organizers usually require the checklist signature pages (mentor and conference).

Suggested Layout Tips: Keep entries concise but clear. Use plastic sleeves for certificates or bulky items. Insert labeled dividers for each section. Number pages in the table of contents. Begin major sections with a summary (e.g., "Leadership Workshops Completed: [List and dates]"). All handwritten work should be

legible. Include a “Reflection” or “Notes” column on logs when possible. For photos and group activities, include captions with names, dates, and event descriptions.

Printability: A logical sequence is Title Page → Candidate Info → Section Tabs. Use a standard font and avoid color printing for text. Tables (like the checklist above) can help reviewers. Ensure any charts or diagrams (e.g. a personal growth plan) are large enough to read.

Table 1. Comparison of Portfolio Sections, Evidence, and Evaluation Criteria (see above table for detail).

Sample Portfolio Entries

Below are three illustrative examples of completed portfolio excerpts (summarized for guidance):

1. **Camper/Outdoor Skills Focus:**

2. *Section II (Lifestyle)*: Includes log of daily exercise regimen with app screenshots and coach’s note (for fitness requirement), and completed answer sheets for Basic Water Safety, Camp Safety, Camping I–II, Temperance. Photos of the candidate safely building a campfire and cooking outdoors with mentor’s caption. Certification: Red Cross first-aid card copy.

3. *Section IV (Community)*: Evidence of leading a weekend camp (inventory list, tent layouts, permission forms) showing leadership in outdoor ministry.

4. *Evidence Format:* Workbooks and photos bound under Section II; service report under Section IV.

5. **Spiritual/Teaching Focus:**

6. *Section III (Spiritual)*: A study journal with dated entries from January to March, reflecting on *Desire of Ages* chapters, plus two social-media posts (printouts) with spiritual quotes and commentary. A bound summary for each Fundamental Belief (one paragraph each, with verses highlighted) [49]. In a notebook, five detailed lesson plans on Creation, Sabbath, Sanctuary, etc., with attendance roster from a Sabbath School class (for teaching requirement).

7. *Share Section:* A link (printout) to a 5-minute recorded devotional video presented to the Pathfinder club, and a community discussion report (two-page write-up on evangelism topics covered).

8. *Evidence Format:* Digital prints in plastic sleeves, journal entries photocopied, binders for lesson plans.

9. **Service/Evangelism Focus:**

10. *Section IV (Community)*: A three-page project report on an ADRA disaster-relief campaign, including photos of the candidate assisting, a letter from the local ADRA director, and a newspaper clipping about the project (fulfills personal evangelism and ADRA honors). Three event flyers and sign-in sheets (with photographs) for youth potlucks and community clean-up drives (fulfills the three fellowship events requirement) [50] [47].

11. *Section I (Leadership)*: Reflection pages from attending a “Youth Evangelism Training” workshop, signed by the conference trainer. Survey printouts (Spiritual Gifts) with a two-page analysis comparing the candidate’s gifts to those of church leaders.
12. *Evidence Format:* Reports collated chronologically under Community; scanned poster prints under Leadership.

Each sample entry should clearly label the requirement it satisfies and be cross-referenced in the table of contents. Reviewers often look for variety in experiences, so these examples illustrate three different emphasis areas.

Timeline for Portfolio Assembly

It is recommended to plan your Master Guide work over **1–3 years**. A rough timeline (using a Gantt chart) might look like:

```
gantt
    title Sample 18-Month Master Guide Timeline
    dateFormat  YYYY-MM
    section Year 1
    Prerequisites (Baptism cert, staff training)  :done, 2025-01, 2025-03
    Leadership Workshops & Awards                :active, 2025-04, 2025-09
    Basic Honors (Water, Camp, etc.)            :2025-10, 2026-01
    Start Devotional Journal                     :2025-10, 2026-12
    section Year 2
    Spiritual Studies (Gospels, DA, Step to Christ):2026-02, 2026-06
    Fundamental Beliefs Summaries                :2026-04, 2026-07
    Organize Church Events                       :2026-05, 2026-11
    Community Service/ADRA Project               :2026-07, 2026-12
    Section 5 (Documentation Prep)               :2027-01, 2027-02
```

Assembly Tips:

- Begin a **Portfolio Folder** early and file documents as you complete each requirement. Do not wait until the end.
- After finishing a requirement, immediately put the evidence into the portfolio (e.g., attach workshop certificates and notes).
- Schedule meetings with your mentor each quarter to review progress and identify missing items.
- Aim to complete all content at least 1–2 months before your planned investiture, allowing time for review and any necessary revisions.
- Submit the portfolio to your Conference Master Guide Committee by the deadline given (often 4–6 weeks before a conference board meeting).

Ethical and Legal Considerations

Master Guide candidates work closely with youth and perform public ministry. SDA policy requires compliance with child safety and confidentiality:

- **Background Checks & Training:** Candidates must complete an approved *Child Protection training course* and any required background/criminal check (often renewed every 3 years) [4] . Conferences usually verify that youth leaders (and even youth candidates) have this clearance.
- **Child Safety:** Always follow your local **Safe Church Policy**. Never be alone with a child without visibility, and report any abuse concerns promptly. (See policies from Adventist Risk Management.)
- **Privacy:** Do not share personal data of minors (addresses, contact info). Include only what's necessary (e.g. first names only for church kids in attendance lists).
- **Photographs and Media Consent:** Obtain written permission (photo/video release) from parents/guardians before including identifiable images of minors in your portfolio or any published work [5] . The NAD form above [5] exemplifies standard release language. Keep signed forms on file.
- **Copyright and Fair Use:** When using external materials (Ellen White excerpts, Bible verses, copyrighted images), cite properly. Do not photocopy entire books. Use small quotes and always attribute (e.g. "{Book}, E.G. White").
- **Spiritual Integrity:** All portfolio work must be your own. Do not fabricate experiences (the Integrity clause in the curriculum manual stresses completion "with commitment and integrity" [51]).

Following these guidelines ensures your portfolio honors the church's ethical standards and protects everyone involved.

Resources and Further Reading

- **Master Guide Curriculum Manual (GC Youth):** *Master Guide Curriculum Manual, 2022 Edition* [1] [52] (official PDF download via the Adventist Youth Ministries website).
- **Master Guide Record Card (GC):** Summarizes all requirements and investiture prerequisites [6] .
- **NAD Club Ministries Master Guide Portfolio:** The North American Division's portfolio workbook (fillable PDF) contains forms, evaluation checklists, and documentation examples [2] [27] .
- **Local Youth Ministries Department:** Check your Division/Union youth department website for any localized Master Guide guides or news (some have adapted curricula or honor lists).
- **Adventurer/Pathfinder Manuals:** Honors requirements (Basic Water Safety, Personal Evangelism, etc.) are detailed on GC's youth site (see gcyouthministries.org under *Pathfinder Honors* and *Master Guide Resource Manuals* [53] [31]).
- **Safe Church Policy:** Adventist Risk Management resources on child protection, such as "Safe Churches a Priority" [54] .
- **Ellen White Writings Online:** *Education*, *Desire of Ages*, *Steps to Christ* and other references are available at egwwritings.org or audioform at ellenwhiteaudio.org [28] [55] .

Summary: Preparing a Master Guide portfolio is an intensive but rewarding process. By following official guidelines, systematically collecting evidence, and reflecting on each experience, candidates demonstrate the leadership, service, and spirituality expected of an SDA Master Guide [1] [6] . Use this document as a roadmap and checklist, and collaborate closely with your mentor and conference leaders throughout the journey.

Sources: Official SDA resources including the Master Guide Curriculum Manual and NAD Master Guide Portfolio guide were used throughout [1] [6] [2] [5] . Specific requirements and policies are cited directly from these materials.

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[1] [3] [8] [9] [10] [11] [12] [13] [14] [15] [16] [17] [18] [19] [20] [21] [22] [23] [24] [25] [26] [28] [38] [52] Master Guide Requirements - Adventist Youth Ministries
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